



Composite shoulder stock

45-round box magazine

Bipod (folded)

▲ RPK74

Date 1976

Origin Soviet Union

Barrel 23½in (59cm)

Caliber 5.45 × 39mm

The light machine-gun version of the infantryman's AK74 assault rifle (see p.246), this weapon features a heavier barrel, which is chrome-lined like the band of the AK74. It also has a modified receiver, a bipod, and an extended magazine. It fires up to 650 rounds per minute.

▼ STEYR AUG LMG

Date 1980

Origin Austria

Barrel 24½in (62cm)

Caliber 5.56 × 45mm NATO

By fitting a bipod and a heavy barrel, Steyr produced a light machine-gun from its AUG assault rifle (see p.250). The AUG LMG can be fitted either with the AUG's standard optical sight/carrying handle combination (as seen here) or without the handle for fitting of a different sight on a rail. It fires around 680–750 rounds per minute.



Ejection port

Bipod

Front grip



Barrel support



Foresight

◀ L86A1 LIGHT SUPPORT WEAPON

Date 1986

Origin UK

Barrel 25½in (64.5cm)

Caliber 5.56 × 45mm NATO

The L86A1 has a heavier and larger barrel than the earlier L85A1 (see p.250), and a rear grip to aid sustained firing. There is no quick-change barrel, so the gun must be fired in short, controlled bursts to prevent overheating. It fires around 610–775 rounds in one minute.



Flash hider

Pistol grip

▲ NEGEV

Date 1988

Origin Israel

Barrel 18in (46cm)

Caliber 5.56 × 45mm NATO

Israel Military Industries' Negev is one of the breed of lightweight automatic weapons that has blurred the distinction between LMG and GPMG. Chambered for the SS109 NATO round in 5.56mm caliber, it can deliver automatic fire at 700 or 900 rounds per minute.

▼ MG43

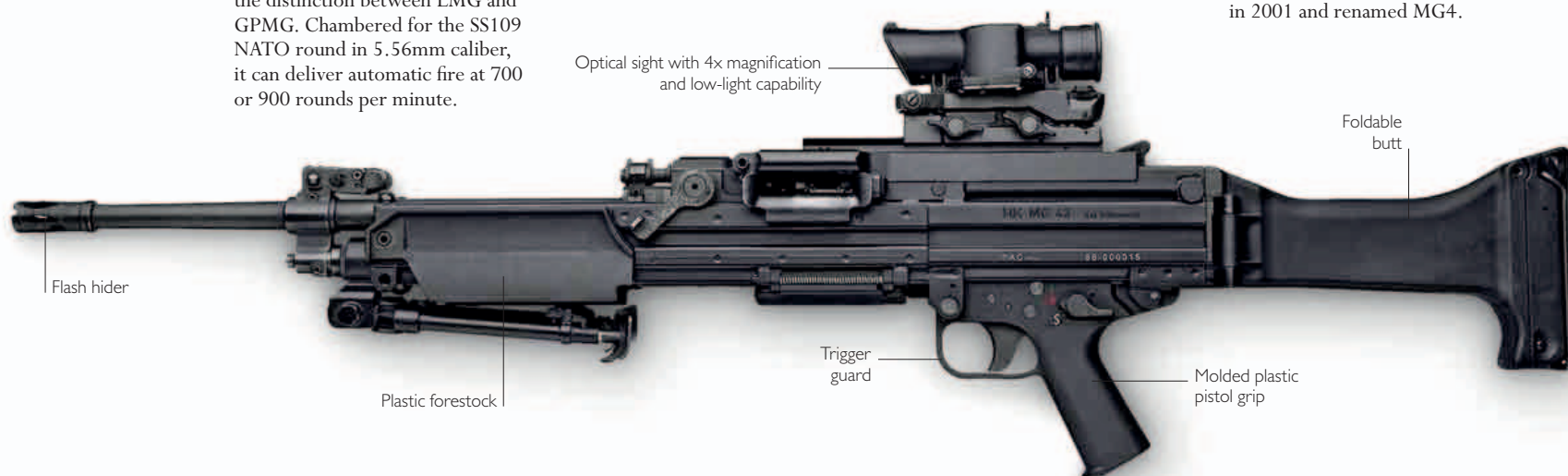
Date 2001

Origin Germany

Barrel 18¾in (48cm)

Caliber 5.56 × 45mm NATO

A rival to the FN Minimi (left), the MG43 is a belt-fed light machine-gun that features a foldable butt and a quick-change barrel. Its rate of fire is about 880 rounds per minute. A slightly modified form was adopted by the German Army in 2001 and renamed MG4.



Flash hider

Plastic forestock

Optical sight with 4x magnification and low-light capability

Trigger guard

Molded plastic pistol grip

Foldable butt